Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Material implementation and critical development

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 3 Part 2 · Big question: How do we translate our Week 1-2 studio brief and joint prototypes into a multi-level structural relief build?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: Why do we build laminated double-thickness beams for Plane 2 and Plane 3 rather than using single thin paper strips?

Correct: Double-thickness lamination creates real physical projection that casts crisp, deep shadow lines under side lighting — Exactly! In relief sculpture, physical height equals shadow contrast.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: What happens visually if every single part of your relief board sits at the exact same flat height? -> There are no projecting edges to catch side light or cast shadows, so the structure looks flat (Yes. Stepping up through Plane 1, Plane 2, and Plane 3 is what gives architectural relief its drama.)

Q2: How do you prevent PVA glue from squeezing out onto your clean negative-space voids? -> Spread a thin, even film of PVA with a card spreader right to the edge rather than

squeezing thick blobs (Correct. Thin spread glue bonds faster and leaves zero shiny blobs in your voids.)

Q3: What should your mid-build critical development note record at the end of today's session? -> How effectively your 3 planes create shadow depth and any deliberate modification you made to strengthen the structure (Spot on. Documenting mid-build problem-solving is essential portfolio evidence.)

Exit check answer

Question: How do you create a deep 'undercut' shadow line beneath a foreground card beam in relief construction?

Correct: Glue a slightly narrower hidden spacer strip underneath the middle of the beam so its outer edges overhang and trap dark shadow — Correct! Hidden spacers lift the beam off the board and cast razor-sharp architectural shadows.